

sectors like healthcare and finance where data residency is mandatory. Google announced that later this year, Indian organisations across all sectors will have the option to store their data at rest and conduct machine learning processing entirely within India, using their large language model, Gemini 1.5 Flash.

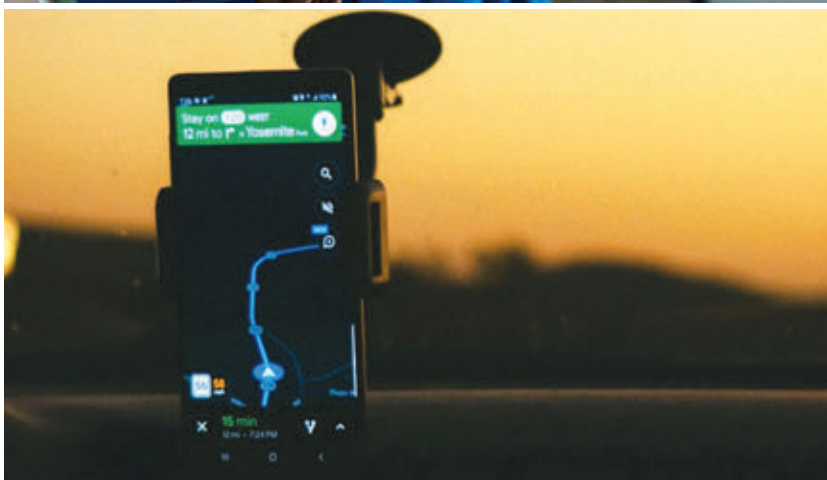
This is another important development, as keeping data within national borders not only complies with regulations but also enhances security and control. For large Indian enterprises wary of sending sensitive data overseas, this move could accelerate the adoption of AI technologies big time. This Google initiative also aligns with the Indian government's push towards digital self-reliance, or 'Atmanirbhar Bharat,' by empowering local organisations with world-class tools while maintaining data sovereignty.

3) Building India's digital health infrastructure

Healthcare in India is a paradox of immense challenges and immense opportunities. Google's collaboration with the Government of India's Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM) is a significant step toward modernising our country's healthcare infrastructure. By supporting the integration of health apps with ABDM's digital architecture, Google aims to reduce the integration time from up to six months to less than two weeks.

Also starting next year, ABHA health ID cards will be accessible on Google Wallet in partnership with Eka Care. This means over 600 million users will be able to securely manage their health information, like lab reports and prescriptions, directly from their smartphones, claims Google.

In terms of healthcare accessibility, this Google's attempt to integrate and drive adoption of ABHA health ID cards – similar to how "GPay" is synonymous with UPI's platform. It could streamline processes, making critical information available when it's needed most. For



rural areas, where medical facilities are sparse, this could be a potential game-changing moment.

4) Gemini Live in 9 Indian Languages

Language diversity is both a strength and a challenge for India. While over 40% of Gemini's Indian users rely on voice interactions, the availability has been limited to English and Hindi. Google is rolling out Gemini Live in Hindi today, with eight more Indian languages – Bengali, Gujarati, Kannada, Malayalam, Marathi, Telugu, Tamil, Urdu – to follow.

By making AI assistants available in regional languages, Google is democratising access to information and services. It opens up possibilities for hundreds of millions who are more comfortable in their mother tongue, rather than force them to use an

unknown language. This move could significantly boost digital literacy and inclusion across the country.

5) Searching with AI Overviews and Video

Google is enhancing search capabilities with AI Overviews in more Indian languages and introducing the ability to search using video through Google Lens. Imagine recording a video of a malfunctioning pressure cooker and asking, "How do I fix this?" The AI provides an overview with helpful links to guide you.

This isn't just a nifty feature; it's a shift towards a more intuitive and accessible internet. For users who may struggle with text-based searches, especially in rural or less literate populations, the ability to search using images and videos can make the digital world far more approachable. **d**